implemented and the regime was showing signs of fatigue over the pressure exerted from the international community. Suu Kyi would spend several months in the Insein prison before being put under house arrest. Even after the horrific event, Suu Kyi was quoted as saying that she was still willing to turn the page and use the situation as an opportunity for dialogue. Unfortunately, the unsuccessful attempt to assassinate Suu Kyi created a larger rift within the ruling junta, leading to further distrust and anxiety within the leadership. Than Shwe claimed that her continued presence created a significant threat to the peace and stability of Myanmar. He claimed that her actions were a threat to national security.

The failed attempt on Aung San Suu Kyi's life put Than Shwe in a position of weakness. Khin Nyunt was now put in charge of trying to rehabilitate the regime's image. The most significant aspect of the rehabilitation was the announcement of the seven-point road map to democracy. This document was to be the guide to the political future of Myanmar that would ultimately lead to democratization. Several secret talks were held between members of the junta and NLD representatives, in particular Than Tun. According to defector Aung Lynn Htut, a final agreement was in place by the spring of 2004. Ultimately the negotiations were futile because Than Shwe rejected the tentative agreement reached between the government representatives and the NLD negotiation team. It was apparent that Than Shwe still had solid control over the decision-making process. This episode led to a final power struggle between Than Shwe and Khin Nyunt. While away on a trip to Singapore, Nyunt's headquarters was raided and evidence of an illicit trade network was uncovered. In October 2004, Nyunt was arrested and subsequently put on trial on corruption charges. This event solidified the status quo until the breakthrough of 2010–2011.

FROM RANGOON TO NAYPYIDAW: THE RELOCATION OF MYANMAR'S CAPITAL

Rangoon has served as the capital of Myanmar since early in the colonial era. As the largest urban area in the country, it was a natural location for the center of government. A monumental change occurred at 6:37 A.M. on November 6, 2005, as hundreds of government servants left Rangoon in